

vided the functionality of a mouse. Thanks to its size and user-friendliness, it is generally considered the first personal computer by many, including the IEEE Computer Society (one among 40 technical societies of the IEEE).



The LINC was the first non-massive PC

July: TV Across The Ocean

The Telstar communications satellite was launched, and relayed the first transatlantic television broadcast. The ground stations were based in the US, France, and Britain. An AT&T project that did not have any government aid, the Telstar programme estimated that “a system of 40 satellites in polar orbits and 15 in equatorial orbits would provide service 99.9 per cent of the time between any two points on earth.” To this end, it intended to launch about 50 communications satellites.

September: The OS Arrives...?

The Atlas Computer became operational at Manchester University. Considered the fastest and most sophisticated computer of its time, it also pioneered concepts like virtual memory and compiler compilers. The Supervisor, a central program that managed the resources of Atlas, is considered a forerunner of today’s operating system.

September: The Laser Diode

Robert Hall demonstrated the laser diode. This type of laser—the semiconductor laser—being easy to create and small in size, is the commonest of lasers. They are currently used in CD drives and laser printers.

Packet Switching: Enabling The Internet Today

Paul Baran designed Packet Switching. The Cold war was at its peak, and concern about the destructibility of the present com-